

Thursday, 25 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 31° 22°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 35° 21°	MANCHESTER Overcast 33° 22°	GLASGOW Overcast 28° 17°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Babies and mothers died after 'systemic' failings.
Donna Ockenden's largest review of NHS maternity services also finds a "bullying and toxic culture".
UK · NEWS
- 2

King meets women's cricket team that is not allowed to exist.
King Charles shows his support for the Afghan women's cricket team, who are no longer allowed to play official games.
UK · NEWS
- 3

Donaldson to give up knighthood and seat on Privy Council.
The moves were confirmed in a statement issued by his solicitor John McBurney.
UK · NEWS
- 4

Trust pays £187k over trans changing room tribunal.
Seven Darlington nurses are being compensated following a dispute over single-sex changing rooms.
UK · NEWS
- 5

Man who died at summer solstice event named.
Police say a 41-year-old man has been arrested on suspicion of murder and remains in custody.
UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Michael Barrymore TikTok videos prompt concern over filming on smart glasses.**
A shop worker tells the BBC he unexpectedly appeared in a video Barrymore uploaded on social media.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Jesy Nelson 'outraged' after MPs debate muscle condition that affects her twins.**
The singer says children face a "postcode lottery", as testing for the disease is staggered.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 GTA 6 will cost \$80 - and physical edition will not contain a disc.**
Rockstar has said physical copies of the game will contain a code for a digital download for the game.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 South Korea could deport stalker who rang BTS star's doorbell 133 times.**
The Brazilian woman visited BTS member Jungkook's home 20 times in less than two months.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Uncovering the West Midlands roots of Thomas the Tank Engine.**
It is Christopher Awdry's measles in the 1942 that led his father to create Thomas the Tank Engine.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Stokes reveals 'highest pressure' of England captaincy.**
Captain Ben Stokes admits England are under the “highest amount of pressure” since he and coach Brendon McCullum took charge four years ago.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Tuchel's England are opposite to Southgate's - and built to beat top teams.**
BBC Sport's football tactics writer Umir Irfan explains why Thomas Tuchel's England system is built to prosper against the world's top nations.
SPORT · UK
- 3 IOC announces new grant for Olympians.**
Every future Olympian will be able to apply for a grant of \$10,000 (£7,600) for each Games they compete in, says the International Olympic Committee.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Why Bellingham was not sent off for covering his mouth.**
England midfielder Jude Bellingham was not shown a red card despite covering his mouth while talking to Ghana's Jordan Ayew.
SPORT · UK
- 5 England to face Scotland? World Cup knockout stage as it stands.**
Use BBC Sport's projections tool with in-game updates to plot your country's route through the World Cup knockouts.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new appreciation for 'community gardens' is blossoming across the UK.**
More neighbourhoods are coming together to transform neglected spaces into vibrant green areas, fostering both local produce and friendships.
- 2 The trend of 'upcycling old furniture' is gaining momentum, transforming forgotten pieces into stylish home additions.**
It's a fantastic way to be eco-friendly and add a unique, personal touch to your living space without breaking the bank.
- 3 Experts are suggesting that indulging in a 'midday nap' could be the secret to increased productivity and a brighter mood.**
Just a short snooze can help to recharge your batteries and improve focus for the rest of the day.
- 4 A delightful new study indicates that spending time near 'water features' like fountains or streams can significantly reduce stress.**
The calming sounds and visual appeal of water have a soothing effect on our minds, promoting relaxation.
- 5 The simple joy of 'board games' is making a big comeback, bringing families and friends together for offline fun.**
From classic favourites to exciting new releases, board games offer a wonderful opportunity for connection and friendly competition.
- 6 More people are discovering the meditative benefits of 'birdwatching' right from their own gardens.**
It's a peaceful way to connect with nature and observe the fascinating world of local wildlife.
- 7 The art of 'homemade greetings cards' is seeing a charming resurgence, adding a personal touch to special messages.**
Instead of buying off-the-shelf, many are enjoying the creative process of crafting unique cards for loved ones.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our houseplants, even though we know they can't understand us?

ANSWER: TALKING TO THEM, SOMETIMES EVEN GIVING THEM NAMES!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a specific 'biscuit' that we always reach for first in a mixed selection. What is it?

ANSWER: THE CHOCOLATE DIGESTIVE, OF COURSE!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a 'word' or a 'phrase' that you absolutely love, and you try to slip it into conversation whenever you can?

What's that one word or phrase that you've picked up recently and just can't get enough of?

- We all have those little 'shortcuts' or 'hacks' that we use in the kitchen to make cooking a bit easier or quicker.

What's your go-to kitchen shortcut that saves you time or effort, even if it's a bit unconventional?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies can only see the colours red, green, and yellow.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£52 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£52 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The British Isles are home to over 100 different types of native trees.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The world's first public park was Birkenhead Park in Merseyside, inspiring New York's Central Park.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch, in Wales.
- Astronauts grow taller in space due to the lack of gravity decompressing their spines.
- The original purpose of chewing gum was to quench thirst and stave off hunger.
- The 'clink' of glasses when toasting originated from a time when people would clink their glasses together hard enough to spill a little into each other's drink, to prove no one was poisoning anyone.

On this day

Day 176 of the year, 189 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Philippines); Christian feast day: David of Munktorp; Christian feast day: Dorothea of Montau; Christian feast day: Eurosia. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2002 — Benson Boone, American singer-songwriter
- 1947 — Jimmie Walker, American actor
- 1964 — John McCrea, American singer-songwriter and musician
- 1940 — Mary Beth Peil, American actress and singer
- 1925 — June Lockhart, American actress (died 2025)
- 1937 — Eddie Floyd, American R&B/soul singer-songwriter
- 1979 — Richard Hughes, Scottish footballer
- 2006 — Mckenna Grace, American actress, singer and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1950 — The Korean War begins with the invasion of South Korea by North Korea.
- 1975 — Mozambique achieves independence from Portugal.
- 1997 — An uncrewed Progress spacecraft collides with the Russian space station Mir.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1996 — American rapper Jay-Z releases his debut album, Reasonable Doubt.
- 2022 — Two people are killed and 21 more injured after a gunman opens fire at three sites in Oslo in a suspected Islamist anti-LGBTQ+ attack.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — PMTair Flight 241 crashes in the Dâmrei Mountains in Kampot Province, Cambodia, killing all 22 people on board.
- 1944 — The final page of the comic Krazy Kat is published, exactly two months after its author George Herriman died.
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1943 — The Holocaust and World War II: Jews in the Częstochowa Ghetto in Poland stage an uprising against the Nazis.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 177 of the year, 188 days left in 2026. Today Day of the Armed Forces of Azerbaijan; Christian feast day: Anthelm of Belley; Christian feast day: David the Dendrite; Christian feast day: Blessed Giacinto Longhin. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1983 — Nick Compton, South African-English cricketer
- 1984 — Aubrey Plaza, American actress
- 1922 — Eleanor Parker, American actress (died 2013)
- 1957 — Al Hunter Ashton, English actor and screenwriter (died 2007)
- 1943 — Georgie Fame, English singer, pianist, and keyboard player
- 1955 — Gedde Watanabe, American actor
- 1952 — Gordon McQueen, Scottish footballer and manager (died 2023)
- 1988 — King Bach, Canadian-American actor, comedian, director, producer, writer and social media personality

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — Air Canada Flight 189, flying to Toronto, overruns the runway and crashes into the Etobicoke Creek ravine. Two of the 107 passengers on board perish.
- 1991 — Yugoslav Wars: The Yugoslav People's Army begins the Ten-Day War in Slovenia.
- 2000 — The Human Genome Project announces the completion of a "rough draft" sequence.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules that the Communications Decency Act violates the First Amendment to the United States Constitution.
- 2007 — Pope Benedict XVI reinstates the traditional laws of papal election in which a successful candidate must receive two-thirds of the votes.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)